HACK876 × JPS FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Students can be part of something bigger.

The JPS Foundation wants students to dream big about innovation and energy. Hack876 gives secondary students one day to build a working answer to a problem they care about, in teams, with mentors beside them.

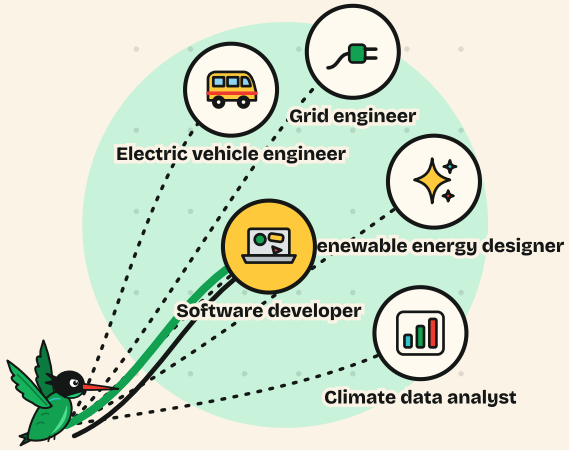
Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

What if young Jamaicans experienced themselves as builders before anyone told them what career they should have?



Before the degree.

Before the first job.

Before anyone hands them a title.

There is usually a first moment when someone realizes: I can build this.

For most young people, that moment arrives late, if it arrives at all.

Hack876 is designed to create more of those moments.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

03 NOT JUST APPS

A hackathon is bigger than software.

Hack876 is an open build competition. Teams choose the problem and the medium.

Some will write code. Some will wire circuits. Some will design a service, a business or a tool nobody has thought of yet.

A team might build:

- A piece of software
- An AI tool
- An automation
- A data product
- A tool for small businesses
- Hardware
- A robot
- A physical prototype
- A resilience solution
- Something none of us expected

The medium does not matter.

The instinct to create does.

From awareness to action, one build at a time.

Hack876 is a day where that motivation turns into something students can switch on and show.

THE JPS FOUNDATION

“We will empower Jamaicans to be good environmental and community development stewards, through volunteerism, STEM Education, and partnership to contribute to a sustainable and prosperous society”[2]

Climate resilience, community empowerment and STEM education are the Foundation's three main pillars.[2]

Sophia Lewis: "The future of our country depends on a skilled and innovative workforce. By supporting students in technical disciplines, we are helping to build capacity and create opportunities for the next generation."[3]

Sophia Lewis at the 2026 Climate Action Conference and Expo: "We don't just want you to be aware of the challenges, we want you to be motivated by the solutions."[4]

On the CAPE/STEM workshops: "They are also able to dream big to know that, although they are students, they can be part of something bigger when it comes to innovation and when it comes to energy management of our nation."[5]

On mentorship: students "benefit tremendously from having access to people who have already walked the path they are about to undertake."[1]

A STEM pathway built around young Jamaicans.

2026

EcoSpark Innovation Challenge

Developed with the Environmental Foundation of Jamaica. Power Up Energy Club finalists and other secondary schools competed in Nature-Based Solutions and Grid Resilience categories, for more than $1.2 million in prizes.[6]

WITH UWI MONA

CAPE/STEM Workshops

A J$16 million, five-year partnership. Sixth-formers study subjects including computing, physics and chemistry, and more than 1,200 students took part in 2026.[5]

2026

CSEC Industrial Technology exam fees

Fees covered for more than 300 students across 20 high schools. The programme has now helped over 3,700 students.[3]

2026

Power Up Scholarships and Mentorship

About $6 million across four categories, with recipients paired with JPS executives for at least three mentoring sessions.[1]

SINCE APRIL 2024

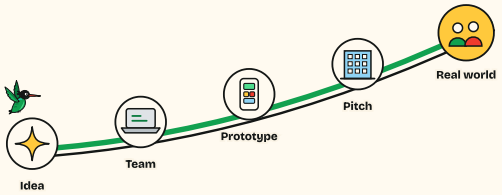
Power Up Energy Club debates

High school Energy Club teams debating climate change and the future of energy over a five-week competition.[2]

PROJECT EDRIVE

Hands-on electric car builds

Primary-aged students built electric cars from robotics kits in sessions hosted with Project eDrive.[2]



Workshops, clubs, a pitch challenge and mentors are already in place. Hack876 adds a single day where students build across every kind of problem, side by side with students from other schools.

9 schools. One room.

St. George's College won the People's Choice Award at the 2026 EcoSpark Innovation Challenge for its Rain Garden within a Miniature Sponge City.[6]

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- **St. George's College**

There are two natural homes for this inside the JPS Foundation.

The Foundation's mission names STEM Education and partnership as two of the ways it works.[2]

PATH 1 · THE FOUNDATION

A STEM education grant

- ✓ Fits the STEM education and climate resilience pillars
- ✓ Complements EcoSpark and the Energy Clubs rather than competing with them
- ✓ A contained, one-day commitment
- ✓ Followed by a short written recap with photos and outcomes

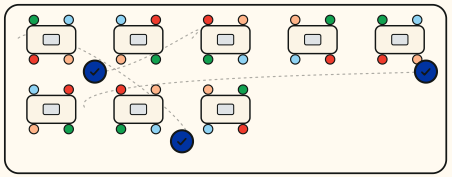
PATH 2 · PEOPLE

Time and expertise from the JPS team

- ✓ Engineers as judges and mentors
- ✓ A short talk on how energy careers really work
- ✓ Volunteers on the day

The JPS Foundation's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

People in the room.



01
Judges

JPS engineers on the panel for the Resilience track, judging how well a build would really work.

02
Mentors

JPS people moving between teams on the day, in the same spirit as the Foundation's Mentorship Programme.

03
Speaker

Sophia Lewis or a JPS engineer on what a career in energy actually looks like.

04
Challenge input

A real energy efficiency or community resilience problem teams could choose to take on.

05
Volunteers

A small JPS team helping with check-in, lunch and the demo floor.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

Many participants are minors. There is no marketing aimed at students, and no student contact details or data are shared with sponsors.

Any hardware or electrical build is supervised by a qualified adult, with safe, low-voltage kits only.

Judging stays independent. A sponsored award is decided by the full judging panel against the published criteria.

The honest answer to the visibility questions.

Will the JPS Foundation be visible? Yes, across event materials, programming and post-event storytelling, at a level that matches the partnership.

Is the audience relevant? It is the next generation of Jamaican builders, professionals and leaders, met early.

Can it build longer relationships? Yes, through people, schools and a second year, not through leads.

WHO IS IN AND AROUND THE ROOM

Ambitious secondary-school students
Approximately 80 of them, from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form.

Parents and families
Who see who showed up for their children.

Teachers and school communities
Across our network of 9 schools in Kingston.

Future university students
Making choices about what to study and where.

Future founders and professionals
Meeting the JPS Foundation early, and in the right way.

Many participants are minors. We will not promise leads, reach, impressions or data.

Become a Gold Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

GOLD PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

The Foundation already funds student prizes through EcoSpark, so contributing toward the Hack876 prizes is a familiar, contained ask. If a smaller first step fits better, a Bronze contribution toward a special award or JPS people on the day would still mean a great deal.

Any amount within the level is welcome. It is a flexible contribution toward the event, with no naming rights attached.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

JPS Foundation

Gold Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Resilience, Move, Learn, Wildcard

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner SUGGESTED	Platinum Partner
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

What each level receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WAYS TO HELP WITH A PRIZE

The planned prizes are iPad per student (up to 4); AirPods Pro per student (up to 4); gift card per student (up to 4). Any of these helps:

- **Donating the item**
- **Donating some of the quantity needed**
- **Gift cards or store credit**
- **A discount on the purchase**
- **A monetary contribution toward buying it**

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

JPS Foundation Power Up Resilience Award (suggestion)

One idea: an award for the best Resilience-track build, in the spirit of EcoSpark's Grid Resilience category. Energy, communities and climate solutions would all count. We would shape the name and criteria together.

13 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Sophia Lewis, Head, JPS Foundation**.[1]

If the JPS Foundation is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ How is Hack876 different from EcoSpark and the Energy Clubs?
- ✓ When and where will it happen, and which schools are confirmed?
- ✓ Will students build hardware, and how is that kept safe?
- ✓ What exactly will our support pay for, and how will we hear about the results?
- ✓ How are students under 18 kept safe on the day?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well. Learn from it.

Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A recurring JPS Foundation award at every edition of Hack876.
- A showcase slot for top Hack876 Resilience builds at a future Climate Action Conference and Expo.
- Inviting Power Up Energy Club members from Hack876 schools to apply.
- A hands-on energy hardware table, in the spirit of the Foundation's robotics and electric car sessions.
- Sharing Power Up Scholarship information with Hack876 finalists heading to university.



HACK876 × JPS FOUNDATION

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Sophia and the JPS Foundation team.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. Jamaica Gleaner, "Built For success: Aspiring civil and medical engineer among JPS Foundation scholars (August 22, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260822/built-success-aspiring-civil-and-medical-engineer-among-jps-foundation

2. JPS Foundation, "2024 Annual Report." www.jpsco.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/JPSF_2024-ANNUAL-REPORT_WEB.pdf

3. Jamaica Observer, "JPS Foundation covers industrial technology CSEC exam fee for over 300 students (April 23, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/04/23/jps-foundation-covers-industrial-technology-csec-exam-fee-300-students/

4. Jamaica Observer, "JPS Foundation's climate conference urges youth to drive Jamaica's road to resilience (March 26, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/03/26/jps-foundations-climate-conference-urges-youth-drive-jamaicas-road-resilience/

5. Jamaica Gleaner, "JPS Foundation, UWI workshop benefits CAPE/STEM students islandwide (January 19, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260119/jps-foundation-uwi-workshop-benefits-capestem-students-islandwide

6. Jamaica Gleaner, "Students, stakeholders drive climate solutions at JPS Expo (March 28, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260328/students-stakeholders-drive-climate-solutions-jps-expo

A private partnership proposal prepared for Sophia Lewis, Head, JPS Foundation.